

The Pessoa Knowledge Graph

A Scholarly Resource for Heteronymic Studies

pessoagraph.org

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What It Is

The **Pessoa Knowledge Graph** ([pessoagraph.org](<https://pessoagraph.org>)) is an open-access, interactive knowledge graph that maps the practice of heteronymy across approximately five thousand years — from pharaonic titulary (c. 2600 BCE) through Fernando Pessoa's canonical system to contemporary practices of chosen names, drag performance, and digital identity. It is a freely available scholarly resource for researchers in Pessoa studies, comparative literature, philosophy of authorship, and media studies.

The graph is not a biography of Pessoa. It is a **typological instrument**: a navigable map of 111 nodes representing instances of heteronymic or para-heteronymic practice, connected by 13 formally typed relations, and classified into 20 node types. Its purpose is to make visible the structural relationships between practices that literary scholarship has traditionally treated in isolation — Pessoa's heteronyms, Kierkegaard's pseudonyms, Bowie's performance personae, contemporary drag houses, chosen pronouns — and to offer these relationships as testable hypotheses rather than settled claims.

What It Contains

111 nodes, including:

- Fernando Pessoa's canonical heteronyms (Caeiro, Reis, Campos, Soares, Barão de Teive, and others)
- Pessoa's orthonymic, semi-heteronymic, and editorial positions
- Historical precursors (pharaonic titulary, monastic naming, Kierkegaard's pseudonyms, Machado's apocrypha, Yeats's partial heteronyms)
- Contemporary literary cases (Araki Yasusada/Kent Johnson, Elena Ferrante, Mark Z. Danielewski)
- Performance heteronymy (David Bowie's Ziggy Stardust/Aladdin Sane/Thin White Duke, MF DOOM, drag culture and ball houses)
- Contemporary digital and identity practices (avatars, handles, chosen names, chosen pronouns)
- The *Pearl and Other Poems* (2014) system and the Crimson Hexagonal Archive heteronyms (the Dodecad)
- Key critical and editorial figures in Pessoa studies (Tabucchi, Zenith, Pizarro, the Campos brothers)
- Vehicles and institutions (*Orpheu*, *Athena*, *Presença*, Olisipo)

13 relation types: master→disciple, influence, created by, published in, theorizes, contemporary of, member of, translated by, instantiates, lineage, manifests, critiques, extends.

20 node types: orthonym, heteronym, semi-heteronym, pseudonym, ancient practice, precursor, contemporary, performance heteronym, cultural heteronymy, meta-heteronym, LOGOS, academic critic, vehicle, concept, and others.

How to Use It

The graph is accessible at **pessoagraph.org** in any modern browser. No account or login is required.

Free exploration. Nodes are displayed in a force-directed layout. Click any node to see its type, biographical summary, connections, and source deposits. Drag to rearrange. Zoom and pan to navigate.

Guided paths. Six curated paths traverse the graph as visual arguments:

1. *"You Are a Heteronymist"* — from digital handle to avatar to pronoun to drag to Bowie to DOOM to Pessoa to despersonalização to meta-heteronym. Demonstrates the thesis that heteronymic practice is a distributed technology of contemporary subjectivity.
2. *"The Naming Lineage"* — 5,000 years from pharaonic titulary to the chosen pronoun.
3. *"The Pearl"* — from the book-object to the archive via Apocalypse 2:17 and the Secret Name.
4. *"Pessoa's Constellation"* — the canonical heteronymic system and its internal relations.
5. *"The Drama in People"* — following Lourenço's structural reading through the graph.
6. *"The Material Turn"* — Pizarro, Lopes, Zenith, and the archival infrastructure.

Each path is a navigable argument. The paths do not merely illustrate; they make claims about the field that can be accepted, contested, or refined.

Piecewise timeline. A timeline visualization distributes nodes across historical periods, allowing scholars to see which practices are contemporaneous, which are precursorial, and which emerge in the digital era.

Machine-readable export. The full graph data is available as JSON-LD, enabling computational reuse, linked-data integration, and further analysis.

Theoretical Framework

The graph's typology draws on the **Heteronymic Provenance Theory** (HPT; Sharks 2026, EA-HPT-01, DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.18305509), which reformulates authorship as a structured relation between biographical person, authorial

position, voice, and text. The node types and relation types are formalized in the **PKG typological schema** (EA-PKG-02, DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.15339368).

The concept of the **meta-heteronym** — a heteronymic system whose personae produce not only works but the institutional conditions of those works' legibility — is introduced in "O Meta-Heterônimo: Heteronímia como Tecnologia Institucional" (Fraction/Sharks 2026, EA-METAHET-01, DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.19683650), which uses the PKG typology as its comparative framework.

Every typological assignment in the graph — every node type, every relation — is a **hypothesis**, not a settled fact. The graph is designed to make these hypotheses visible and contestable. Scholars who disagree with a classification (Is Yasusada a meta-heteronym or merely a failed hoax? Is Ferrante's anonymity a zero-heteronym or a pseudonym? Is a drag persona a heteronym or a performance identity?) are invited to engage with the specific node and its stated rationale.

Technical Details

Stack: Vite + React + d3.js

Data format: JSON-LD (linked data, machine-readable)

Hosting: Static deployment, freely accessible

License: CC BY 4.0 (data and visualization)

Source code: Available in the Crimson Hexagonal Archive GitHub repository

Foundation Deposits

The Pessoa Knowledge Graph is anchored by three Zenodo deposits:

EA-PKG-01 — The Pessoa Knowledge Graph: A Federated Linked-Data Representation of the Heteronymic System. DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.15339353

EA-PKG-02 — Heteronymic Typology: A Formal Classification of Authorial Voices in Pessoa and Beyond. DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.15339368

EA-PKG-03 — The New Human: Post-Pessoa Heteronymic Practice in the AI Era. DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.15339374

The interactive visualization is deposited separately:

EA-PKG-VIS-01 — pessoagraph.org — Pessoa Knowledge Graph Visualization v1.0. DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.19672980

How to Cite

When citing the graph as a scholarly resource:

Sharks, Lee. Pessoa Knowledge Graph. pessoagraph.org. Crimson Hexagonal Archive, 2026. Foundation data: EA-PKG-01 to EA-PKG-03 (DOIs: 10.5281/zenodo.15339353, 10.5281/zenodo.15339368, 10.5281/zenodo.15339374). Visualization: EA-PKG-VIS-01 (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.19672980).

When citing a specific typological claim from the graph (e.g., classifying Bowie as a performance heteronym):

Sharks, Lee. "Heteronymic Typology: A Formal Classification of Authorial Voices in Pessoa and Beyond" (EA-PKG-02). Zenodo, 2026. DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.15339368.

An Invitation

The Pessoa Knowledge Graph is offered to the community of Pessoa scholars not as a replacement for philological work in the archive, but as a **complementary instrument** — a way of making visible the comparative geometry of heteronymic practice that the textual archive, by its linear nature, can only describe sequentially. The graph shows; the archive tells. Both are needed.

The typology is open to correction. The relations are open to refinement. The node classifications are open to debate. The graph is infrastructure for hypotheses, not a monument to conclusions.

The invitation is simple: visit pessoagraph.org. Navigate. Disagree. Refine. The graph improves by being used.

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